

GSS Trends & Design Effects: Missingness Over Time and DEFF

General Social Survey 1972–2018 (cumulative n = 75,699). Panel B uses 2018 with full complex design.
Design: svydesign(id=~vpsu, strata=~vstrat, weights=~wtssall, nest=TRUE). survey.lonely.psu = 'adjust'.

A. Has Income Non-Response Gotten Worse? (GSS 1972–2018)

Missingness rate by year for four key variables. Income refusal (MNAR) has risen from ~25% to ~40%. Happiness missingness (MCAR) has stayed flat at ~5%. Loess trend lines (dashed) highlight the secular pattern.



B. Design Effects: How Much Does Clustering Inflate Standard Errors?

DEFF > 1 means the complex design (stratification + clustering) inflates SEs vs. simple random sample.
DEFF = 2 means the effective sample size is HALF the actual n. GSS 2018, n = 2,348.

